

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Bears aim to unveil stadium plans this fall



The Bears are working to make the former Arlington International Racecourse in Arlington Heights the site of their new stadium and entertainment district. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Arlington Heights project to be financed by team, needs lawmakers' approval for tax negotiations

By Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

The Chicago Bears are expected to publicly present their latest plans for a new stadium in Arlington Heights this fall, officials said, with the hope of breaking ground by spring.

Bears President Kevin Warren and other officials are meeting regularly to refine their plan with Arlington Heights village officials. Sometime in September, October or November, the team will make

a public presentation and answer questions about the 326-acre site, according to Arlington Heights Mayor Jim Tinaglia. Then the village planning, design and housing commissions will review the proposal before it goes to a Village Board vote. The whole process could take a few months.

The latest push for a new stadium comes as a new NFL season kicks off, and as competitors throughout the league are in the midst of a building boom. New stadiums in Nashville and Buffalo

are getting record public subsidies, and teams in Cleveland, Jackson-ville, Kansas City, and Washington, D.C., angling for their own deals.

While the Bears have raised fan expectations with a new coach and players — the team will play its season opener Monday night — they have yet to finalize the stadium proposal, four years after they first pitched a dome in Arlington Heights.

The Bears have said they will finance the new stadium themselves, but the deal still hinges on state lawmakers allowing the team to negotiate its property taxes.

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NEW SEASON, NEW ERA: With Ben Johnson as the Bears' new head coach, expect an emphasis on running the ball. The season starts Monday night at Soldier Field against the Vikings. **Chicago Sports**

McDonald's franchisees allege racial bias in suit

Black owners accuse company of history of discrimination

By Darcel Rockett
Chicago Tribune

For 25 years, Robert Bonner was committed to working under McDonald's iconic Golden Arches. But by the time the native Floridian had severed ties with the franchise founded in Des Plaines by Ray Kroc in 1955, he burned everything that was related to the restaurant chain — awards, shirts, valuable collectibles — in his backyard.

Bonner was the owner-operator of six McDonald's stores in Illinois and the St. Louis region. But he left the chain after enduring numerous alleged racist actions from McDonald's that he says impeded his opportunity for entrepreneurial growth and generational wealth.

"Those Golden Arches ... you have the belief that at some point this is going to go the way you were promised it would go," he said. "The day you get the keys, it becomes an us and them mentality, corporate versus the people who run the store."

Bonner is among dozens of Black McDonald's store owners around the nation demanding a jury trial in a racial discrimination and breach of contract lawsuit against McDonald's Corp. and McDonald's USA, LLC. This June, Bonner was among more than 40 plaintiffs who called for a boycott of the franchise. The Chicago-based civil rights law firm of Loevy + Loevy filed the federal suit in 2023, stating Black owner and operators were forced out of the company over internal practices and policies that include, among others, forcing Black owners into low-profit stores in areas with high crime rates and denying Black franchisees the ability to buy stores in white

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INSIDE

Trump: Israel OKs his terms of truce

The president claimed on social media that Israel has accepted his terms for a ceasefire in Gaza and urged Hamas to do the same. **Nation & World**

Pop star Dua Lipa ahead of the pack

The singer-songwriter made a case for belonging among the ranks of pop's elite performers in her concerts at the United Center. **Arts & Living**



Army veteran Tony Walker and his wife, Rosemary, put a jacket on daughter Kamari, 2, before day care on Thursday at their home in Plainfield. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

DEVASTATED BY AN OVERSIGHT

Records show the VA failed to treat a Plainfield father's common infection. Now he and his family are paying the price

By Andrew Carter | Chicago Tribune

Anthony Walker always liked to think of himself as "the man." He always liked to think of himself as "tough Tony."

That's how he felt jumping out of planes while in the Army and stationed at Fort Bragg in North Carolina. He felt it later, too, as a small-business owner, husband and a father to six children.

"A provider," said Walker, 49, trying to define what being "the man" meant to him.

"I might sound like a caveman," he said in self-deprecation and, amid all the things he'd lost, at least he still had a sense of humor. "And, if I do, please forgive me."

But caveman or not, he always aspired for his family "to depend on me. For me to be (a) macho man."

"Tough Tony, is what I called myself at one point in time," he said.

But that was before Walker, a Plainfield resident, began suffering from fatigue and swelling in his leg. It was before his admission to the Edward Hines Jr. VA Hospital, and before doctors there missed a bacterial infection that a routine blood test revealed. It was before that infection lingered, for weeks, and triggered sepsis. And before the heart surgery that followed, and then the strokes, the tears, the slow assisted steps while he learned how to walk again.

"I feel like a baby," he said recently as he sat in his attorney's office in the Loop.

His wife, Rosemary, sat to his right, crying. It was the day after their lawyers filed a federal lawsuit accusing the VA of negligence that left Walker severely disabled and his wife to be his caretaker. Walker's plight, one of his attorneys said, is reflective of a larger problem as health care for American military veterans has found itself in political crosshairs.

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Courts brake Trump's immigration policies

Agenda blocked by several suits, rulings

By Ben Finley
Associated Press

President Donald Trump has promised to remove millions of people from the United States in the largest deportation program in American history. But his immigration agenda is facing various

tests in the U.S. courts.

A U.S. appeals court ruled last week the Trump administration can't use an 18th-century wartime law to speed deportations of alleged Venezuelan gang members, setting up a likely Supreme Court showdown.

Some of the president's policies affect hundreds of thousands, if not millions, of people. Some affect individuals, like Philipos Melaku-Bello, a volun-

Trump downplays post: "We're not going to war" with Chicago, he says. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

teer who has manned a decades-old peace vigil for years near the White House. He said Park Police removed it early Sunday morning.

Trump, who ordered the removal, attended the U.S. Open tennis tournament Sunday in New York to a mixed reaction.

Here are some Trump efforts under court scrutiny.

Alien Enemies Act

The administration has used the Alien Enemies Act of 1798 to remove people it accused of being in the Tren de Aragua gang, arguing that it's an invading force.

The administration deported people it designated as

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